

Award
FINRA Dispute Resolution Services

In the Matter of the Arbitration Between:

Claimant

Robert W. Baird & Co. Incorporated

Case Number: 25-01511

vs.

Respondent

Stephen W. Simpson, Jr.

Hearing Site: Boston, Massachusetts

Awards are rendered by independent arbitrators who are chosen by the parties to issue final, binding decisions. FINRA makes available an arbitration forum—pursuant to rules approved by the SEC—but has no part in deciding the award.

Nature of the Dispute: Member vs. Associated Person

REPRESENTATION OF PARTIES

For Claimant Robert W. Baird & Co. Incorporated (“Claimant”): Jessica L. Newman, Esq., Robert W. Baird & Co. Incorporated, Louisville, Kentucky.

Respondent Stephen W. Simpson, Jr. (“Respondent”) did not enter an appearance.

CASE INFORMATION

Statement of Claim filed on or about: July 24, 2025.

Claimant signed the Submission Agreement: August 12, 2025.

CASE SUMMARY

In the Statement of Claim, Claimant asserted a cause of action for breach of promissory note.

RELIEF REQUESTED

In the Statement of Claim, Claimant requested compensatory damages in the amount of \$286,517.40; costs, including the filing fee; interest; attorneys’ fees; expenses; and any further relief deemed appropriate.

OTHER ISSUES CONSIDERED AND DECIDED

The Arbitrator acknowledges having read the pleadings and other materials filed by the parties.

Respondent did not file a Statement of Answer. Accordingly, this matter proceeded pursuant to Rule 13807(e)(1) of the Code of Arbitration Procedure ("Code").

On October 8, 2025, Respondent registered for the DR Portal, providing Respondent with access to all documents filed in the case, including the Statement of Claim, Overdue Notice, and Notification of Arbitrator. Therefore, Respondent is bound by the Arbitrator's ruling and determination.

AWARD

After considering the pleadings, the Arbitrator has decided and determined in full and final resolution of the issues submitted for determination as follows:

1. Respondent is liable for and shall pay to Claimant the sum of \$286,517.40.
2. Respondent is liable for and shall pay to Claimant interest on the above-stated sum at the rate of 4% per annum from April 1, 2025 through and including the date of full repayment.
3. Respondent is liable for and shall pay to Claimant \$1,250.00 to reimburse Claimant for the non-refundable portion of the filing fee previously paid to FINRA Dispute Resolution Services.
4. Respondent is liable for and shall pay to Claimant \$300.00 to reimburse Claimant for the Paper Decision Fee previously paid to FINRA Dispute Resolution Services.
5. Any and all claims for relief not specifically addressed herein, including any requests for attorneys' fees, are denied.

FEES

Pursuant to the Code, Claimant has paid to FINRA Dispute Resolution Services the \$2,640.00 Member Surcharge and \$5,040.00 Member Process Fee previously invoiced.

Claimant has also paid to FINRA Dispute Resolution Services the \$1,250.00 non-refundable portion of the filing fee and the \$300.00 Paper Decision Fee.

ARBITRATOR

Arthur J. Giacomarra

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Sole Public Arbitrator

I, the undersigned Arbitrator, do hereby affirm that I am the individual described herein and who executed this instrument, which is my award.

Arbitrator's Signature

Arthur J. Giacomarra

Arthur J. Giacomarra
Sole Public Arbitrator

11/17/2025

Signature Date

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November 17, 2025

Date of Service (For FINRA Dispute Resolution Services use only)